

Admissions Committee
PhD Program in Informatics and Computing
Northern Arizona University

Dear Members of the Admissions Committee,

I am pleased to recommend Sherif Shawshen for admission to the PhD program in Informatics and Computing at Northern Arizona University. I have directly managed Sherif as an ERP Developer Intern at Contact Financial Holding since September 2025. In this role, he has consistently demonstrated strong engineering fundamentals, unusual curiosity about “why” decisions were made, and a systems-oriented mindset that I associate with research potential.

One example stands out: I asked Sherif to optimize PL/SQL procedures in our compensation rules engine that were slowing during peak processing. He did not only apply routine tuning; he examined architectural trade-offs (including transaction isolation implications), clarified constraints, and documented the rationale behind his choices. His work reduced response time by approximately 40%.

Sherif also contributed to Oracle APEX financial reporting dashboards and user-management functionality, where he showed careful attention to data integrity, maintainability, and stakeholder requirements. He communicates clearly, handles feedback professionally, and improves designs without losing sight of operational constraints—qualities that make him reliable in real systems and credible in technical discussions.

I remember talking with Sherif about what motivates him to excel, and he mentioned that building dependable systems with real-world impact drives his work, which aligns well with doctoral training in informatics, especially research involving complex data workflows and decision-support systems, and I recommend him without reservation because I believe he will contribute to your research community.

Sincerely,
Amr Saad
Senior Oracle APEX Developer, Contact Financial Holding
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